

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

A Sticky Problem

Q I just purchased a Sony Ericsson K750i. When I record a movie or sound, or even click photographs and save them on the provided Memory Stick, and try to access them later, the photos appear blocky and movies fail to play. Even when I play MP3s stored on the card, they crackle. I do not experience such problems with files saved on the phone's internal memory.

Mahesh Naik

A You probably have a damaged Memory Stick Duo card. Try and use the phone with a different Memory Stick to verify that the problem is with the Memory Stick and not with the phone itself. If your phone is under warranty, take it to the reseller from whom you bought it; remember that the Memory Stick is covered by the warranty, so if that's where the fault lies, you will get a replacement.

The Sound Of Silence

Q I'm facing problems after having installed Red Hat Linux Enterprise WS v3 (Taroon). Everything runs fine, but sound doesn't seem to work. I have an Intel Pentium 4 2.4 GHz processor on an Intel 865GBF motherboard with 256 MB RAM.

Dipayan Samanta

A The Red Hat Linux Enterprise WS v3 (Taroon) has inbuilt support for onboard audio devices based on the AC97 codec. Since the Intel 865GBF motherboard has such an audio device onboard, it is, of course, supported by this flavour of Linux. Download the open source ALSA drivers from www.alsa-project.org and install them. These drivers support most sound devices.

It Works Both Ways

Q Is there paid or free software to convert DVD movies to Xvid (not DivX)?

Runeet Saraf

A SimpleDivX is a good and easy-to-use free-ware application that can convert DVD movies to DivX as well as Xvid. It is available from www.simpdivx.org.

A Burning Issue

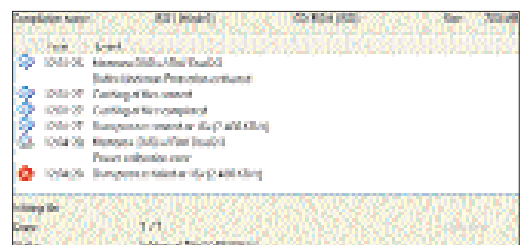
Q I have a Pentium 4 1.6 GHz, 256 MB of RAM, an 80 GB hard disk running Windows XP Pro, and

a Samsung CD-Writer with Nero burning software. When I try to burn a video compilation or even just data, I get a message saying "Burn process failed, power calibration error". I cannot burn even at 4x. What can I do?

Sunil Malhotra

A There are several points to mention when it comes to the "Power Calibration Error":

1. The first and easiest method to deal with the problem is to download the latest firmware for your CD-Writer and flash it. You can get the latest firmware from the Samsung Web site (www.samsungodd.com).
2. Try changing the brand of the media you are using to see if the problem goes away.
3. Power consumption can also be an issue. To check if this is the case, disconnect the power connectors of all the devices that are not neces-



Nero Power Calibration Error

sary for the burning process.

4. The error could be because of the accumulation of dust on the lens. Use a lens-cleaning CD, or if you are comfortable with the idea, you can also open the unit and clean it. Remember, this voids your warranty.
5. If the writer is under warranty, avail of it: if your dealer finds that he cannot burn a disc using the writer and the bundled software, he will probably be willing to replace the writer.

"Sony NS-11": Beware

Q I bought an MP3 player with pen drive (256 MB) with a "5 in 1" option. The model number printed on the drive is "Sony NS-11". After I formatted the drive, the capacity changed to 120 MB. Is it possible to recover the lost memory?

M D Kishore

A You've been taken for a ride by your dealer. This MP3 player is not from Sony, and it has been reported that while it may display a capacity of 256 MB, it decreases to 120 MB the first time you format it. There is no way to recover the lost space—simply because the drive does not have 256 MB of space! The "NS-11" is a fake MP3 player that has swamped our markets.

A Question Of Voltages

Q Can an AGP 8x card work in an AGP 4x slot?

Joe

A Yes, all AGP 8x cards are backwards-compatible, and can work with motherboards that